TRUNKBELAY · PROJECT PLAN

TrunkBelay project plan

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
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REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.2	2026-10-25	Amish Chadha	O6 to O8 decided by Amish (2026-10-25); rig for the 3.5 kN proof load and the test to failure
0.1	2026-10-25	Amish Chadha	First project plan (kit 1.9.1 upgrade) at stage P3

TrunkBelay project plan

TrunkBelay is at stage P3 (design outputs, TRL 3): the constructable design of option A, its model at detail level D3, drawings, priced BOM, build plan and the pipeline documents are in place. The next gate, P4 (verification, TRL 4), is on hold while the portfolio cap is P3. Decisions requested from Amish now: the concept selection between options A and B (TKB-DEC-001 O5), the strength target (O7) and the appearance of the new renders (O6). Method: STANDARDS sections 19 and 23.

> **Safety:** P4 work is the first time the kit meets a load and a person. It starts with the friction and proof tests on cut trunk sections and a dummy drill at low height, never with a person (TKB-BLD-001, section 6).

Workstreams

Table 1. Workstreams.

Workstream	Owner (role)	Deliverable	Status
Problem, users and requirements	Project lead	TKB-PRB-001 v0.4, TKB-URS-001, TKB-PRS-001, TKB-RTM-001	Done at P3; to confirm with a co-design partner
STEM check and concept options	Design lead	TKB-STM-001, TKB-OPT-001, TKB-DDR-004	Done; STEM check open (field data); concept selection awaiting Amish (O5)
Design and calculations	Design lead	Model (`cad/src/model.py` , D3), TKB-CAL-001 v0.3, drawings TKB-DWG-001 and 101 to 109, BOM	Done at TRL 3
Build plan	Design lead	TKB-BLD-001	Done (a plan, not yet built)
Regulatory, risk and market	Project lead	TKB-REG-001, TKB-RSK-001, TKB-MKT-001, TKB-FEA-001	Done at P3; G8 and G9 to assess with the partner
Co-design partner	Project lead	Agreement with a training programme, a fire station or a climbers' collective	Not started (none approached)
Verification (P4)	Test partner	Friction and proof tests on trunk sections, dummy drill, timed drill	On hold (stage cap P3)
Validation (P5)	Co-design partner	Training trial and supervised drills with climbers	On hold

Resources needed

Table 2. Resources for P4 (planned, on hold). Costs are estimates and are not added to the value-engineering target.

Resource	Deliverable	Effort	Estimated cost (USD)
One prototype kit (BOM)	The kit to test	Fabrication about 2 days	828 (BOM)
Cut coconut trunk sections, 200, 300 and 450 mm, wet and dry	Friction and proof test specimens	1 day with the partner	To assess
Test rig able to apply 2.5 kN, the 3.5 kN proof load and a sample frame's breaking load (about 5 kN or more), and measure slip (CalRig shared block)	Friction, proof, slip and failure tests (O7)	2 to 3 days	To assess
100 kg test dummy and a 3 m training pole or palm	Dummy drill and timed drill	1 day	To assess
Trainer from the partner programme	Drill card and the half-day session	1 day	To assess

Stage gates

Table 3. Stages (P4 to P6 on hold while the stage cap is P3).

Stage	Gate criteria	Status
P0 Proposal	PRB with users and stakeholders, STM, OPT, REG, FEA, PLN	Met (2026-10-25)
P1 Definition	URS, PRS draft, RSK with hazard analysis, MKT, REG complete	Met (2026-10-25)
P2 Design inputs	PRS with targets and verification, CAL, RTM, concept selection DDR, STM closed, feasibility closed	Met except: STM open (18 plausible rows on field data, S30 among them until the test to failure Amish decided on 2026-10-25, O7) and the concept selection awaiting Amish (O5)
P3 Design outputs	Model, STEP, drawings, priced BOM, build plan, DEC, design FMEA, traceability complete	Met (2026-10-25); cad/fidelity.json passes at D3
P4 Verification	Friction and proof tests on trunk sections; dummy drill; timed drill; RSK updated	On hold
P5 Validation	Training trial with climbers; field use with a partner	On hold
P6 Commercialization	Only with a named deployment partner	On hold

Next steps and decision requested

1. Amish decides O5 (option A or B) in TKB-DEC-001; O6, O7 and O8 were decided on 2026-10-25.
2. The coordinator renders `media/options.png` and the product views on the studio machine (Blender Cycles), replacing the labelled preview.

3. When the cap allows P4: approach the Friends of Coconut Tree training programme and a Kerala Fire and Rescue Services station; the first test is the friction of the pads and sleeved chain on wet trunk sections.

References

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